



FOSS Bytes

Dell and Canonical introduce Ubuntu Moblin Remix

Canonical, partnering with Dell, recently unveiled Ubuntu Moblin Remix Developer Edition. The offering, based on Moblin version 2, is optimised for Dell's Inspiron Mini 10v netbook that became available since September 24th, this year.

According to a joint press release, Ubuntu Moblin Developer Edition "gives developer communities a great platform to develop and test Moblin and associated applications." This piece of news mitigates potential concern about Moblin pushing aside Ubuntu as a popular mobile Linux operating system. Instead, the Dell-Canonical effort allows Moblin services and the Moblin graphical user interface to run atop Ubuntu.

However, Dell's promise to re-introduce desktop PCs with Ubuntu still remains unfulfilled.



Yahoo! may sell off Zimbra

As Yahoo works to reposition itself as a more consumer facing company, it is looking at some of the businesses it has acquired over the years and how they fit. One of them that doesn't appear to have a place in the new Yahoo is Zimbra, which, according to Channel Register [<http://ow.ly/qrs4>], is up for sale.

Yahoo acquired the open source e-mail company back in September 2007 for \$350 million. The goal was to use Zimbra's technology as a foothold into the white-label e-mail business and to improve Yahoo Mail.

Apparently, Comcast and Google are amongst the companies being courted to purchase Zimbra, although the sale price is likely to be far less than the \$350 million Yahoo paid. With Zimbra, Yahoo! had an opportunity to dominate the white label collaboration and e-mail space. Instead, it let the product languish and allowed Google to take a big chunk of the business.

Android's on a roll

Android seems to have caught the phone manufacturers' fancy, big time. This month, there have been a slew of releases on the platform. While HTC has been touting its brand new hero with HTC Sense, Samsung is also planning to introduce India to its very first phone with Google's OS in the core, called the Galaxy. Then there is LG Etrna to drool on. Motorola has joined the bandwagon and designed a completely customised user interface for Motorola Cliq and Dext, all on top of the open source operating system, Android.

Moreover, to prove Android's popularity, Facebook has finally come out with an official Android app—something they had refused to do earlier, hoping the developer community would get its hands dirty. Google's Eric Chu has also announced several upgrades to the Android Market that will feature in Android 1.6. In a post on the official Android Developers' blog, Chu revealed that new changes to the Android Market would allow developers to add screenshots, promotional icons, and improved app descriptions to show off their apps and games better.



US FCC to mandate 'network neutrality' for the Web

The head of the United States Federal Communications Commission (FCC) plans to propose new rules that would prohibit Internet service providers from interfering with the free flow of information and certain applications over their networks. The guiding idea is that the big cable companies that build the information highway shouldn't exert much control over where users drive.

The FCC chief Julius Genachowski proposed two new guidelines, plus a strengthening of existing FCC standards:

- *Providers can't favour their own content*—Providers of broadband Internet services cannot discriminate against particular Internet content or applications. This would cover the emerging arena of wireless broadband services, delivered to smart phones.
- *Providers need to explain variable Internet speeds*—Broadband providers should disclose their network management practices to consumers. This might include policies that cause some users to face a squeeze on their connection speed during times of peak traffic on the network.
- *Providers can't limit access to lawful content*—These standards say that network operators cannot prevent users from accessing the lawful Internet content and applications.